

TEXAS STATE MILITIA



Militia Uniform Standard Operating Procedure

TEXAS STATE MILITIA

Version 1.1

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1 FORWARD AND PURPOSE

1.1 FORWARD

In today's dynamic world, the significance of the uniform extends far beyond its mere fabric and design. It serves as a symbol of honor, discipline, and unity, embodying the values and ethos of the Texas State Militia.

1.2 PURPOSE

Uniformity, particularly in public, is paramount to establishing TSM as a professional and competent organization in the public's perception. This manual will serve as a foundation to ensure that every Militia member has a basic understanding of the proper wear of the TSM uniform. As such, every member will be required to maintain a professional appearance when representing the Texas State Militia. With the exception of 4.1.1, uniform choice is at the Commander's discretion.

2 DEFINITIONS

2.1 CAMOUFLAGE PATTERN - MULTICAM

- 1) Multicam is the official uniform camouflage pattern adopted by TSM statewide.
 - a. The only Multicam pattern approved is the original and excludes any of the variants.
 - b. OCP may be worn instead of Multicam, but they cannot be mixed due to variance in the pattern.
- 2) History of the Multicam pattern
 - a. Developed in 2002 by Crye Precision.
 - b. Utilized by over 60 countries including Russia, Ukraine, N. Korea, China, and NATO allies.
 - c. Numerous variants exist including country-specific patterns as well as Arctic, Tropical, and black.
- 3) Multicam has demonstrated its ability to blend in a wide variety of environments. The Multicam pattern offers the most flexible concealment options while allowing TSM members to maintain their uniformity across all companies.

2.2 HEADGEAR

- 1) Patrol cap.
 - a. Standard, Army issue Multicam or Marine Corps “8-point” Multicam.
 - b. Markings
 - i. Rank on center front.
 1. can either be sewn or pinned,
 - ii. Last name on the rear of the headband.
 1. can either be hook and loop or sewn.
 - iii. Radio call signs may be substituted at commanders’ discretion.
 - c. Patrol cap must be worn during any TSM-sanctioned events in the public eye.
- 2) Tactical cap
 - a. Baseball style cap.
 - b. Must be Multicam except for company S3. Which is OD
 - c. Garrison Markings
 - i. Rank will be affixed to the front center if there is a hook and loop panel.
 - ii. Nametape will be affixed to the back hook and loop panel if equipped.
 - d. Field Markings

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- i. If equipped with a hook and loop panel, a member may affix 1 of 3 patches:
 - 1. rank,
 - 2. a subdued “forward” Texas flag,
 - 3. or the state organizational patch.
 - ii. Nametape will be affixed to the back hook and loop panel if equipped.
- e. Recruiter Markings
 - i. may be worn with any of the patches mentioned above as long as the recruiters are uniform in their presentation.

*Everyone must own one of the above-mentioned caps.

- 3) Watch (fleece) cap.
 - a. Subdued in color.
 - b. Nothing will be affixed to the watch cap.
- 4) Sun “Boonie” hat
 - a. Multicam
 - b. Rank may be affixed but is not required. If affixed, rank must either be subdued pin-on style or sewn, centered on the hat.

3 GENERAL GUIDELINES

3.1 CARE OF THE UNIFORM

- 1) Uniforms are to be kept neat and serviceable.
- 2) Uniforms that are excessively worn or otherwise in disrepair will be considered unserviceable and will not be authorized.
- 3) Wash uniforms separately from other clothes using the recommended instructions on the tag.
 - a. Wash in cold water using a mild detergent free of optical brighteners and bleach.
 - b. Dry on low heat (not to exceed 130 degrees F). Remove immediately from the dryer and fold flat or place on a rustproof hanger to ensure heat from the dryer does not set wrinkles. To drip dry, remove from the washer and place on a rustproof hanger. Do not wring or twist.
 - c. Do not use fabric softeners or dryer sheets.
 - d. Remove all patches and pins not sewn on before laundering.
 - e. Fasten all buttons, close zippers, and turn inside out before laundering.
 - f. Wash tops and bottoms together to keep a uniform color fading over time.
 - g. Do not dry clean or starch your uniform under any circumstances. This will ruin it.

TAKE CARE OF YOUR UNIFORM AND IT WILL TAKE CARE OF YOU!

3.2 GROOMING STANDARDS

The reason TSM stands apart from other less organized militias is our professional bearing. To maintain this bearing, members should always attempt to present themselves respectably. Each militiaman and militiawoman is expected to maintain a professional appearance while participating in sanctioned events.

3.2.1 Hair

- 1) Hair is to be kept in a neat and orderly condition.
- 2) Members with long hair are to keep it in a bun if possible. Ponytails that hang out of the uniform coat are not authorized.
- 3) Extreme or eccentric haircuts (mohawks, etc.) Are not authorized.
- 4) Colors that detract from a professional appearance are not authorized.

3.2.2 Facial Hair

- 1) While facial hair is authorized, it is not recommended as it can interfere with SCBAs and gas masks. It can also pose a safety hazard when operating machinery.
- 2) If a militiaman chooses to keep facial hair, it is to be kept neat and tidy to not detract from a professional appearance.

3.2.3 General Grooming

- 1) Fingernails are to be kept clean and tidy. No fingernails are authorized that are of an unnatural length or color.
- 2) Militia members will maintain good personal hygiene and grooming daily to not detract from their overall professional appearance.

3.3 TATTOOS AND PIERCINGS

- 1) Earrings are to be kept minimal. Males are not permitted to wear earrings while in uniform.
- 2) Facial piercings are not authorized while in uniform.
- 3) Tattoos are authorized but should be in good taste. Offensive, extremist, or discriminatory tattoos are not authorized. Facial tattoos are not authorized.
*The company commander reserves the right to judge tattoos on a case-by-case basis and make an exception to this policy.

4 GARRISON UNIFORM

The standard uniform for the Texas State Militia.

The ACU or the IHWCU (Improved Hot Weather Combat Uniform) is authorized but cannot be mixed.

4.1 WHEN TO WEAR

- 1) Deployed in any mission or activity that could bring a member into contact with other organizations or the public.
- 2) More than 75% of activities will be classroom or tabletop exercises.
- 3) A member's primary job is in HQ.

4.2 COAT

- 1) ACU Coat (must be worn with ACU trousers)
- 2) IHWCU Coat (must be worn with IHWCU trousers)
- 3) Markings
 - a. Name, organizational tapes, and rank may either be sewn on or utilize the hook and loop but must be one or the other.
 - b. Chaplains will wear branch insignia in place of rank.
 - c. Circular Organization patch and tabs centered on the left shoulder. (The old style “Pentagon” shaped patch will not be authorized after the wear-in date.
 - d. Company and subdued “Multicam” reverse Texas flag centered on right shoulder.
 - e. Medics will wear a “MEDIC” brassard above the organizational patch on the left shoulder.
 - f. State shop leads will wear a shop designation brassard above the organizational patch on the left shoulder.
 - g. No individual patches (morale) are authorized on the uniform.
 - h. No Medical Identification Patches are authorized. i.e., NKDA, Blood Type, etc.
 - i. The US flag is not authorized.
 - j. Foreign flags are not authorized.
- 4) Sleeves may be rolled at the commander’s discretion.
 - a. If sleeves are rolled, they must be rolled in the proper military fashion. The commander will designate whether sleeves will be rolled with the camouflage visible or inside out.
 - b. The sleeves may be cuffed inwards.
- 5) Pockets will be buttoned or zipped closed.

4.3 TROUSERS

- 1) ACU Trousers (must be worn with ACU coat)
- 2) IHWCU Trousers (must be worn with IHWCU coat)
- 3) Worn buttoned and with a belt. Militia members will wear the trousers tucked into the top of the boots or bloused using the drawstrings at the bottom of the trousers or using commercial blousing devices if the trousers are not tucked into the boots. The legs of the trousers must be long enough to allow blousing over the combat boots. Militia members will not wrap the trouser leg around the leg tightly enough to present a pegged appearance or insert any items inside the trouser leg to create a round appearance at the bottom of the trouser leg. When bloused, the trousers will not extend below the third eyelet from the top of the boot.
- 4) Pockets will be buttoned closed.

4.4 UNDERSHIRT

- 1) Tan 499
- 2) OD green, foliage green, or company shirts may be substituted at the commanders' discretion.

4.5 BELT

- 1) Tan 499

4.6 BOOTS

- 1) AR670-1 compliant coyote brown
- 2) Boot laces are to be tucked into boots.

4.7 HEADGEAR

- 1) Patrol cap (both the Army and Marine Corps version is authorized).
- 2) Tactical ball caps in Multicam
- 3) Subdued watch caps (in cold weather)
- 4) Sun "boonie" hats may be worn at the commander's discretion, but never in public.

5 FIELD UNIFORM

This uniform is worn in place of the garrison uniform when weather or activities make wearing the garrison uniform unfavorable.

5.1 WHEN TO WEAR

- 1) Any mission or activity where a member will be wearing a plate carrier or LBE.
- 2) Any FTX where a member's primary job will have them in the field more than 25% of the time.

5.2 COMBAT SHIRT

The combat shirt is designed to provide flame protection while maximizing breathability, moisture management, and comfort. It will be worn tucked into the trousers. It is designed to be worn next to the skin, without a t-shirt, in hot weather. This does not preclude the wear of female undergarments or t-shirts currently approved for wear. This shirt will only be worn in a deployed or field environment, as approved by the commander.

- 1) Markings
 - a. Unit patch on the left shoulder (except for state shop leads who will wear the state patch).
 - b. Right shoulder will have subdued reverse Texas flag, rank centered, and 4" nametape below.
 - c. Unit level patches are authorized at the commander's discretion.
 - d. No individual patches (morale) are authorized on the uniform.
- 2) Sleeves may be cuffed.

5.3 COMBAT PANTS

- 1) With or without kneepad inserts.
- 2) Combat pants do not have to be bloused if they are tapered leg "Crye Precision" style.
 - a. If ACU trousers are worn, they must be tucked or bloused.

5.4 BELT

- 1) Tan 499 or coyote brown
 - a. Combat (war) belt hook and loop may be worn.

5.5 FOOTWEAR

- 2) AR670-1 compliant coyote brown.

5.6 HEADGEAR

- 1) Ball cap
- 2) Subdued watch caps (cold weather only)
- 3) Sun “boonie” hat

6 RECRUIT UNIFORM

Worn by non-patched recruits if they do not own a garrison uniform.

6.1 SHIRT

- 1) tan or olive green (plain or TSM shirt)

6.2 PANTS

- 1) Subdued cargo or tactical pants
- 2) No shorts

6.3 BELT

- 1) Any belt suitable for outdoor activities (web belt preferred)

6.4 BOOTS

- 1) Dark-colored work or hiking boots.

6.5 HEADGEAR

- 1) Subdued color ball cap
- 2) Sun “boonie” hat in a subdued color

7 PUBLIC AFFAIRS UNIFORM

This uniform is to be worn when attending a public activity when wear of the garrison uniform would be discouraged.

7.1 WHEN TO WEAR

- 1) All recruiting activities in public forums.
- 2) When attending any government-sponsored training where a member will be representing the Texas State Militia.

7.2 SHIRT

- 1) Solid-color polo with full-colored TSM organizational logo embroidered on the left breast.
 - a. Name and rank may be embroidered on the right breast but is not required.

7.3 UNDERSHIRT

- 1) Not required. If one is worn, it must be a standard white crew neck undershirt.

7.4 PANTS

- 1) Pants suited for the outdoors, such as:
 - a. Cargo pants
 - b. Hiking pants
 - c. Work pants.
 - d. Tactical / 5.11 style pants
- 2) The color should be Khaki or coyote, but any subdued color will suffice per the commander's discretion.

7.5 BELT

- 1) web belt/riggers belt.
- 2) subdued color

7.6 FOOTWEAR

- 1) coyote brown combat boots.
- 2) subdued work boots

7.7 HEADGEAR

- 1) Not required. Tactical caps are authorized.
- 2) Hair is kept neat and clean.

8 PARADE UNIFORM

The formal or ceremonial uniform of the Texas State Militia.

***SEE GARRISON UNIFORM**

8.1 WHEN TO WEAR

- 1) When performing any honor guard duties
- 2) When taking part in any drill and ceremony events in public

8.2 HEADGEAR

- 1) black beret with either unit or “1836” flash.
- 2) Officers will have non-subdued rank pinned on flash.

8.3 ASCOT

- 1) White

8.4 SHOULDER CORD

- 1) Light grey and white

8.5 BELT

- 1) Black pistol belt

8.6 GLOVES

- 1) White cloth

8.7 BOOTS

- 1) Black leather, shined.
- 2) Jungle boots are authorized.

9 COLD WEATHER AND WET GEAR

9.1 COLD WEATHER GEAR

- 1) Subdued colors are authorized.
 - a. Must not have any logos or writing on them.
- 2) Massif-style IWOL jackets or tan fleece ECWCS are preferred.
 - a. If worn, name tapes and rank must be affixed in the proper location.
- 3) Subdued watch caps are authorized.
- 4) Subdued neck gaiters and shemaghs are authorized at the commander's discretion.
- 5) Subdued cold weather moisture-wicking undershirts, thermals, and “wooly pullys” are authorized to be worn under the combat uniform coat in place of the undershirt.

9.2 WET GEAR

- 1) ECWCS Gen II and Gen III wet weather gear is preferred, but any subdued rain gear is authorized.
 - a. If a Gore-Tex jacket is worn, slide-on rank must be affixed to the jacket.
 - b. When worn properly, the ECWCS can be worn instead of the ACU.

10 PUNITIVE ACTION AND REVIEW

10.1 PUNITIVE ACTION

While this manual contains procedural outlines for proper wear of the uniform, it also contains provisions that are punitive. Failure of a militia member to adhere to the uniform policy outlined in this manual will result in progressive disciplinary actions up to and including dismissal from the organization.

10.2 REVIEW

This SOP will be reviewed periodically by the CO Board to assess its effectiveness and relevance.